

Word family: **mistake / mistakes / mistook / mistaken / mistaking / mistakenly**

Base word: mistake

Plural noun: mistakes

Past tense: mistook

Past participle: mistaken

-ing form: mistaking

Adverb: mistakenly

Useful constructions/extensions: make a mistake, by mistake, mistake A for B, be mistaken, mistaken belief, mistaken identity, if I'm not mistaken, there's no mistaking, learn from mistakes

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adjective and adverb forms (相關形容詞及副詞)

Your passage contains:

> "She never judges me too quickly, even when I **make mistakes**."

Here, **mistake** means:

something you do, say, decide, or understand incorrectly.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **make mistakes**

mistake means:

an incorrect action, decision, judgment, or piece of work caused by misunderstanding, carelessness, lack of knowledge, etc.

The sentence suggests that:

- * you sometimes do something wrong;
- * you may make a poor decision;
- * you may misunderstand something;
- * you may fail in some small way.

But your grandmother does not judge you immediately because of it.

Meaning: An action, decision, judgment, or result that is incorrect.

繁體中文：因判斷錯誤、理解不足、疏忽等而做錯的事情 / 錯誤

****中文翻譯：****

> “She never judges me too quickly, even when I make mistakes.”

「就算我****犯錯****，她也不會太快批評我。」

So:

****make a mistake = 犯錯 / 做錯事情****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****mistake = error in action/judgment (錯誤) — 錯誤；過失****

This is the exact core meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** Something done, said, believed, or decided incorrectly.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She never judges me too quickly, even when I ****make mistakes****.”

「即使我****犯錯****，她也不會太快評價我。」

Practice 2

> “Everyone ****makes mistakes****.”

「每個人都會****犯錯****。」

Practice 3

> “I made a small ****mistake**** in the report.”

「我在報告裡犯了一個小****錯誤****。」

****mistake = 某個行動、判斷、決定、理解或結果不正確****

2. ****make a mistake (犯錯) — 做錯；犯錯****

A major fixed collocation.

Practice 4

> “I **made a mistake** and sent the email to the wrong person.”

「我**犯了錯**，把電郵寄錯人了。」

Practice 5

> “Don’t be afraid to **make mistakes**.”

「不要害怕**犯錯**。」

make a mistake = 做出不正確的行動 / 判斷 / 選擇

Important collocation:

>  make a mistake

not normally:

>  do a mistake

3. **mistake** = wrong answer/calculation/detail (答錯 / 算錯 / 細節錯) — 錯處；錯誤

Practice 6

> “There is a **mistake** in the calculation.”

「計算中有一個**錯誤**。」

Practice 7

> “I found three spelling **mistakes**.”

「我發現了三個拼字**錯誤**。」

mistake = 文字、計算、答案、資料等具體內容中的不正確部分

This remains within the broader “error” sense.

4. **mistake** = poor decision (錯誤決定) — 錯誤選擇；判斷失誤

A major abstract branch.

Practice 8

> “Leaving the job was a **mistake**.”

「離開那份工作是一個**錯誤決定**。」

Practice 9

> “It was a mistake to ignore the warning.”

「忽視警告是一個**錯誤的決定**。」

mistake = 後來證明是不明智 / 帶來不良結果的選擇或決定

5. **It was a mistake to + verb** (做.....是錯的) — **錯誤決定**

Practice 10

> “It was a **mistake to rush** the decision.”

「太快作決定是個**錯誤**。」

Practice 11

> “It would be a mistake to give up now.”

「現在放棄會是一個**錯誤的決定**。」

it is/was a mistake to do = 做某事是不明智或不正確的

6. **mistake = misunderstanding / wrong belief** (誤解) — 誤會；錯誤理解

A useful conceptual extension.

Practice 12

> “I was under the **mistake** that the meeting started at ten.”

This construction is less idiomatic than:

> “I was under the **mistaken impression**...”

So in modern learner English, prefer:

> **mistaken belief/impression**

rather than bare **mistake** for this concept.

7. **mistake** = verb: confuse one person/thing with another (認錯) — 把.....錯認為.....

A major separate verb meaning.

Practice 13

> “I **mistook** him for his brother.”

「我把他**錯認成**他的兄弟。」

Practice 14

> “She **mistook** the sound for an alarm.”

「她把那個聲音**誤以為是**警報。」

mistake A for B = 錯把 A 當成 B ; 誤認身份 / 性質

This is genuinely different from:

> make a mistake.

8. **mistake A for B** (把 A 誤認為 B) — 認錯 ; 誤以為

Practice 15

> “People often **mistake** confidence for arrogance.”

「人們常常把自信**誤認為**傲慢。」

Practice 16

> “I **mistook** the building for a hotel.”

「我把那棟建築**誤認為**酒店。」

****mistake A for B = 因兩者相似 / 判斷錯誤而把其中一個當成另一個****

Literal or abstract.

9. ****be mistaken (弄錯了) — 搞錯 ; 判斷錯誤****

A major participial/adjectival use.

Practice 17

> “I may be ****mistaken****, but I think we’ve met before.”

「我可能****記錯 / 搞錯了****，但我覺得我們以前見過。」

Practice 18

> “You are ****mistaken**** about the date.”

「你把日期****弄錯了****。」

****be mistaken = 某人的理解、記憶、判斷或看法不正確****

10. ****if I’m not mistaken (如果我沒記錯) — 如果我沒搞錯****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 19

> “If I’m not ****mistaken****, the meeting starts at three.”

「****如果我沒記錯****，會議三點開始。」

Practice 20

> “If I’m not mistaken, she used to live here.”

「****如果我沒搞錯****，她以前住在這裡。」

****if I’m not mistaken = 用較謹慎的方式表示自己相信某資訊正確，但保留可能記錯 / 判斷錯的空間**

**

11. **mistaken belief/impression (錯誤觀念 / 印象) — 誤解 ; 錯誤想法**

A major adjective use.

Practice 21

> “He had the **mistaken belief** that success would be easy.”

「他錯誤地認為成功會很容易。」

Practice 22

> “I was under the **mistaken impression** that the shop was open.”

「我原本**誤以為**那間店有營業。」

mistaken + belief/impression/idea = 建立在錯誤理解上的看法 / 印象

12. **mistaken identity (認錯人 / 身份錯認) — 身份誤認**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 23

> “The arrest was a case of **mistaken identity**.”

「那次拘捕是一次**認錯人 / 身份誤認**。」

Practice 24

> “It was simply a case of mistaken identity.”

「那純粹是一宗**認錯人的事件**。」

mistaken identity = 把某人錯認成另一個人

13. **mistaken for + noun (被錯認為) — 被誤以為 ; 被認錯**

Practice 25

> “She was **mistaken for** her sister.”

「她被**錯認為**自己的姐姐 / 妹妹。」

Practice 26

> “The harmless object was mistaken for a weapon.”

「那件無害物品被**誤認為**武器。」

be mistaken for X = 被別人錯誤地辨認 / 理解成 X

14. **mistakenly (錯誤地) — 誤以為 ; 錯誤地**

A major related adverb.

Practice 27

> “I **mistakenly** sent the file to the wrong address.”

「我**誤把**檔案寄到錯誤地址。」

Practice 28

> “She mistakenly believed the meeting had been cancelled.”

「她**錯誤地以為**會議已經取消。」

mistakenly = 因誤解、錯誤判斷或不正確資訊而做 / 相信某事

15. **by mistake (不小心 ; 誤) — 錯手 ; 無意中**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 29

> “I deleted the file **by mistake**.”

「我**不小心 / 誤**刪了檔案。」

Practice 30

> “She took my bag by mistake.”

「她**不小心拿錯了**我的袋。」

****by mistake = 不是故意地，而是因疏忽、混淆或錯誤而發生****

16. ****mistake vs deliberate action (錯誤而非故意) — 無意犯錯****

Practice 31

> “It was an honest ****mistake****.”

「那只是一個****無心之失****。」

Practice 32

> “Don’t punish him too harshly—it was a mistake.”

「不要太嚴厲處罰他——那只是一次****無心的錯誤****。」

****mistake = 一般暗示不是故意做錯，與蓄意行為相對****

This nuance is very important.

17. ****honest mistake (無心之失) — 無意犯的錯****

A useful expression.

Practice 33

> “It was an ****honest mistake****.”

「那只是個****無心之失****。」

Practice 34

> “Anyone could have made that honest mistake.”

「任何人都可能犯這種****無心的錯****。」

****honest mistake = 沒有惡意、欺騙或故意成分的真正錯誤****

18. ****simple/small mistake (小錯誤) — 小錯 ; 輕微錯誤****

Practice 35

> “It was only a ****small mistake****.”

「那只是一個****小錯誤****。」

Practice 36

> “One simple mistake caused the delay.”

「一個****小小的錯誤****造成了延誤。」

****small/minor mistake = 影響較小、嚴重程度不高的錯誤****

This remains under the general error sense.

19. ****serious/big mistake (嚴重錯誤) — 大錯 ; 嚴重失誤****

Practice 37

> “Ignoring the warning was a ****serious mistake****.”

「忽視警告是一個****嚴重錯誤****。」

Practice 38

> “Hiring the wrong person was a big mistake.”

「聘用錯誤的人是一個****很大的失誤****。」

****serious/big mistake = 帶來重大後果或顯示重大判斷失誤的錯誤****

20. ****costly mistake (代價高昂的錯誤) — 造成重大損失的錯誤****

Practice 39

> “The company made a **costly mistake**.”

「公司犯了一個**代價高昂的錯誤**。」

Practice 40

> “One costly mistake damaged the project.”

「一個**造成重大損失的錯誤**破壞了項目。」

costly mistake = 造成大量金錢、時間、聲譽等損失的錯誤

21. **common mistake** (常見錯誤) — 常犯的錯

Practice 41

> “This is a **common mistake** among learners.”

「這是學習者很**常犯的錯誤**。」

Practice 42

> “A common mistake is to translate every word literally.”

「一個**常見錯誤**是把每個字逐字翻譯。」

common mistake = 很多人容易犯 / 反覆出現的錯誤

22. **learn from your mistakes** (從錯誤中學習) — 吸取教訓

A major fixed expression.

Practice 43

> “You should **learn from your mistakes**.”

「你應該**從錯誤中學習 / 吸取教訓**。」

Practice 44

> “She made mistakes but learned from them.”

「她犯過錯，但也**從中學習**。」

****learn from mistakes = 利用過去的錯誤改善之後的判斷 / 行為****

Very relevant to the emotional message of your passage.

23. ****repeat the same mistake (重犯同樣錯誤) — 重蹈覆轍****

Practice 45

> “Don’t ****repeat the same mistake****.”

「不要****重犯同樣的錯誤****。」

Practice 46

> “He kept making the same mistake.”

「他一直****犯同樣的錯****。」

****repeat/make the same mistake = 再次犯之前已出現過的同類錯誤****

24. ****correct/fix a mistake (改正錯誤) — 糾正 ; 修正****

Practice 47

> “I corrected the ****mistake****.”

「我****改正了錯誤****。」

Practice 48

> “We still have time to fix the mistake.”

「我們仍然有時間****補救 / 修正這個錯誤****。」

****correct/fix a mistake = 把不正確的內容 / 結果修改回正確狀態****

25. ****admit a mistake (承認錯誤) — 承認犯錯****

Practice 49

> “She admitted her **mistake**.”

「她**承認自己的錯誤**。」

Practice 50

> “It takes courage to admit a mistake.”

「**承認錯誤**需要勇氣。」

admit a mistake = 接受並公開承認自己做錯 / 判斷錯

26. **own up to a mistake** (承認錯誤 ; 較口語) — 坦白承認

Practice 51

> “He eventually **owned up to the mistake**.”

「他最後**坦白承認了錯誤**。」

Practice 52

> “It is better to own up to your mistakes.”

「最好**坦白承認自己的錯誤**。」

own up to a mistake = 誠實承認自己犯了錯，尤其之前沒有承認時

Useful fixed extension.

27. **mistake** = typographical/writing error (筆誤 / 文字錯誤) — 文書錯誤

Practice 53

> “There is a **mistake** in the date.”

「日期有一個**錯誤**。」

Practice 54

> “The document contains several typing mistakes.”

「文件中有幾個**打字錯誤**。」

****mistake = 文件、文字或輸入內容中出現的不正確項目****

Again, contextual subtype rather than a new core sense.

28. ****mistake = factual error (事實錯誤) — 事實有誤****

Practice 55

> “There is a factual ****mistake**** in the article.”

「文章裡有一個****事實錯誤****。」

Practice 56

> “The report contains several mistakes about the dates.”

「報告中有幾個關於日期的****錯誤****。」

****mistake = 陳述的資訊與實際事實不符****

29. ****mistake = error in language (語言錯誤) — 語法 / 用詞錯誤****

Practice 57

> “I made a grammar ****mistake****.”

「我犯了一個****文法錯誤****。」

Practice 58

> “Don’t worry about small pronunciation mistakes.”

「不要太擔心小的****發音錯誤****。」

****language mistake = 語法、拼字、用詞、發音等不符合目標語言形式****

30. **there's no mistaking + noun (絕不會認錯 / 非常明顯) — 絕對很明顯**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 59

> “There's **no mistaking her voice**.”

「她的聲音**絕對不會認錯**。」

Practice 60

> “There was no mistaking his disappointment.”

「他的失望**非常明顯，絕不可能看不出來**。」

there's no mistaking X = X 的特徵非常明顯，不可能與其他事物混淆 / 錯認

31. **make no mistake (別搞錯 / 毫無疑問) — 別弄錯；要清楚明白**

A common emphatic expression.

Practice 61

> “**Make no mistake**, this will be difficult.”

「**別搞錯 / 要清楚知道**，這件事會很困難。」

Practice 62

> “Make no mistake about it: preparation matters.”

「**這一點不要搞錯**：準備很重要。」

make no mistake = 強調接下來的說法很確定、必須清楚理解

Usually rhetorical/formal.

32. **mistake-proof / error-proof idea (避免錯誤的 ; family extension) — 防呆的**

Mistake-proof occurs, though **error-proof** and **mistake-proofing** are especially common in process/quality contexts.

Practice 63

> “The design is intended to be **mistake-proof**.”

「這個設計的目的是做到**防呆、盡量避免使用者犯錯**。」

Practice 64

> “They introduced mistake-proofing into the process.”

「他們在流程中加入了**防錯 / 防呆設計**。」

mistake-proof = 設計成不容易因人為錯誤而失敗的

Useful workplace/quality extension, but secondary.

Important distinction: mistake vs error

These overlap strongly, but register differs.

mistake

is very common everyday English and often emphasizes:

> a person did/judged/understood something incorrectly.

error

often sounds more formal/technical and is common in:

- * computing;
- * mathematics;
- * science;
- * systems;
- * official documents.

Compare:

> “I made a mistake.”

everyday.

> “The system returned an error.”

technical.

Not every **error** is naturally called a personal **mistake**.

Important distinction: **mistake vs **fault****

**mistake**

= something was done/judged incorrectly.

**fault**

can mean:

- * responsibility/blame;
- * defect;
- * technical failure.

Compare:

> “I made a mistake.”

= 我做錯了。

> “It was my fault.”

= 是我的責任 / 是我的錯。

A mistake is an error; fault concerns responsibility more directly.

Important distinction: **mistake vs **wrong****

**mistake**

= noun or verb.

> “That was a mistake.”

**wrong**

= adjective/adverb/noun-like use.

> “That answer is wrong.”

So:

****mistake = 錯誤這件事****

****wrong = 不正確的狀態 / 性質****

Important distinction: **mistake vs accident**

**mistake**

= incorrect judgment/action.

**accident**

= unintended event, often involving chance.

Compare:

> “I sent the wrong file by mistake.”

= 我因為搞錯而寄錯。

> “I dropped the glass by accident.”

= 我意外把杯掉了。

There is overlap because both can be unintentional, but the cause differs.

Important distinction: **by mistake vs by accident**

These are close but not identical.

**by mistake**

= because of an error/confusion.

> “I took your bag by mistake.”

I thought it was mine.

by accident

= unintentionally/chance.

> “I knocked the cup over by accident.”

No mistaken identification required.

Important distinction: **mistake vs misunderstanding**

mistake

= broad incorrect action/judgment.

misunderstanding

= specifically incorrect understanding, often between people.

> “It was a misunderstanding.”

= 雙方理解出了問題。

Not every mistake is a misunderstanding.

Important distinction: **mistake vs misjudge**

mistake

= broad error.

misjudge

= make an incorrect judgment/estimate.

> “I misjudged the distance.”

more specific than:

> “I made a mistake about the distance.”

Important distinction: ****make a mistake vs do something wrong****

****make a mistake****

= commit an error, often unintentionally.

****do something wrong****

can be broader and can imply:

- * incorrect action;
- * inappropriate behaviour;
- * morally wrong behaviour.

So ****wrong**** can carry a moral dimension that ****mistake**** often does not.

Important distinction: ****mistake vs bad decision****

****mistake****

can be recognized afterwards as wrong/unwise.

****bad decision****

explicitly evaluates the decision itself negatively.

A mistake could involve:

- * typing;
- * memory;
- * calculation;

not just decisions.

Important distinction: ****mistake A for B vs confuse A with B****

These are very close.

****mistake A for B****

= believe A is B.

> “I mistook him for his brother.”

confuse A with B

= fail to distinguish them correctly.

> “I often confuse the two brothers.”

Mistake for focuses strongly on assigning the wrong identity.

Important distinction: **mistake for vs think**

Compare:

> “I mistook him for a doctor.”

= I incorrectly identified him as a doctor.

> “I thought he was a doctor.”

= I believed he was a doctor.

The second does not emphasize mistaken visual/identity recognition as strongly.

Important distinction: **be mistaken vs make a mistake**

make a mistake

= perform/commit an incorrect action or judgment.

be mistaken

= hold an incorrect belief/judgment.

> “I made a mistake in the calculation.”

> “I was mistaken about the date.”

Different grammar and emphasis.

Important distinction: **mistaken vs wrong**

mistaken

usually describes:

- * belief;
- * impression;
- * assumption;
- * person's judgment.

wrong

is much broader.

> mistaken belief ✓

> wrong belief ✓

But:

> wrong answer ✓

> mistaken answer

much less natural in ordinary use.

Important distinction: **mistakenly vs accidentally**

mistakenly

= because of incorrect belief/judgment.

accidentally

= unintentionally.

> "I mistakenly thought she was the manager."

incorrect belief.

> "I accidentally dropped the phone."

unintended event.

Important distinction: ****honest mistake vs deliberate lie****

****honest mistake****

= genuinely incorrect but without intention to deceive.

****lie****

= deliberate false statement.

This is why calling something:

> an honest mistake

often reduces moral blame.

Important distinction: ****small mistake vs serious mistake****

****small/minor mistake****

= limited consequences.

****serious/major mistake****

= important negative consequences.

The lexical sense remains “error”; severity changes through the modifier.

Important distinction: ****mistake vs typo****

****typo****

= typing/printing error specifically.

****mistake****

= broad category.

Every typo is a mistake/error, but not every mistake is a typo.

Important distinction: **mistake vs miss**

mistake

= error.

miss

can mean:

- * fail to hit;
- * fail to notice;
- * fail to attend;
- * feel absence.

They are not interchangeable.

> “I missed the answer.”

means something different from:

> “I made a mistake in the answer.”

Important distinction: **learn from mistakes vs regret mistakes**

learn from mistakes

= use errors to improve future behaviour.

regret mistakes

= feel sorry about them.

Your passage’s tone strongly supports the first attitude:

> mistakes do not justify immediate harsh judgment.

Important distinction: **there’s no mistaking vs unmistakable**

These are close.

> “There’s no mistaking her voice.”

≈

> “Her voice is unmistakable.”

Both mean:

> the identifying features are so distinctive that confusion is extremely unlikely.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **mistake** family is relatively compact but highly useful because the noun and verb differ substantially:

- * **mistake** — error = 錯誤
- * **make a mistake** = 犯錯
- * **mistake in a calculation/text** = 計算 / 文字錯誤
- * **mistake — poor decision** = 錯誤決定
- * **it was a mistake to do** = 做.....是錯誤 / 不明智
- * **mistake A for B** = 把 A 誤認為 B
- * **be mistaken** = 搞錯 / 判斷錯
- * **if I’m not mistaken** = 如果我沒搞錯
- * **mistaken belief/impression** = 錯誤觀念 / 誤解
- * **mistaken identity** = 認錯人
- * **be mistaken for** = 被誤認為
- * **mistakenly** = 錯誤地 / 誤以為
- * **by mistake** = 不小心 / 誤
- * **honest mistake** = 無心之失
- * **small/minor mistake** = 小錯誤
- * **serious/big mistake** = 嚴重錯誤
- * **costly mistake** = 代價高昂的錯誤
- * **common mistake** = 常見錯誤
- * **learn from your mistakes** = 從錯誤中學習
- * **repeat the same mistake** = 重犯同樣錯誤
- * **correct/fix a mistake** = 改正錯誤
- * **admit a mistake** = 承認錯誤
- * **there’s no mistaking** = 絕不會認錯 / 非常明顯
- * **make no mistake** = 別搞錯；要清楚明白
- * **mistake-proof** = 防錯 / 防呆的

The main semantic branches are:

> ****an error in action, judgment, or information****

> ****an unwise decision****

> ****incorrectly identify one thing/person as another****

> ****hold an incorrect belief****

plus several important fixed expressions.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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mistake — error	某個行動、判斷、理解、資料或結果不正確
make a mistake	做出不正確的行動 / 判斷 / 選擇；犯錯
mistake in text/calculation	文字、答案、計算或資料中的不正確部分
mistake — poor decision	後來證明不明智或帶來不良結果的決定
it was a mistake to do	表示做某件事情是不明智 / 不正確的
mistake A for B	因判斷錯誤，把 A 誤認為 B
be mistaken	某人的記憶、理解、判斷或看法不正確
if I'm not mistaken	謹慎表示自己相信某資訊正確，但承認可能搞錯
mistaken belief/impression	建立在錯誤理解上的信念 / 印象
mistaken identity	把某個人錯認成另一個人
be mistaken for X	被別人錯誤辨認 / 理解成 X
mistakenly	因誤解或錯誤判斷而做 / 相信某事
by mistake	並非故意，而是因混淆、疏忽或錯誤而發生
honest mistake	沒有惡意 / 欺騙意圖的真正無心之失
small/minor mistake	影響及嚴重程度較低的錯誤
serious/big mistake	可能造成重大後果的嚴重錯誤
costly mistake	造成大量金錢、時間、聲譽等損失的錯誤
common mistake	很多人容易犯 / 經常出現的錯誤
learn from mistakes	利用過去錯誤改善之後的判斷 / 行為
there's no mistaking X	X 的特徵非常明顯，不可能與其他事物混淆
make no mistake	強調接下來的說法確定、不可誤解；別搞錯
mistake-proof	設計成不容易因人為錯誤而失敗的

For your original passage

> “She never judges me too quickly, even when I ****make mistakes****.”

The exact meaning is:

****mistake = an incorrect action, decision, judgment, or result****

and:

****make mistakes = 犯錯 / 做錯事情****

The emotional nuance is important.

The sentence does ****not**** say:

> you deliberately behave badly.

It says that, like everyone else, you sometimes:

- * misunderstand;
- * make poor choices;
- * do something incorrectly;
- * fail to get something right.

And your grandmother does not immediately reduce your whole character to that one error.

So the contrast is:

- > ****make a mistake****
- > = do something wrong

but not necessarily:

- > ****be a bad person****

The most important learner contrasts are:

- > ****make a mistake****
- > = 犯錯

- > ****a mistake in the report****
- > = 報告中的錯誤

- > ****it was a mistake to leave****
- > = 離開是個錯誤決定

- > ****by mistake****
- > = 不小心 / 誤

> ****an honest mistake****

> = 無心之失

> ****mistake him for his brother****

> = 把他錯認成他的兄弟

> ****be mistaken about the date****

> = 把日期弄錯

> ****if I'm not mistaken****

> = 如果我沒記錯 / 搞錯

> ****mistaken identity****

> = 認錯人

> ****mistaken belief****

> = 錯誤觀念

> ****mistakenly believe****

> = 誤以為

> ****learn from your mistakes****

> = 從錯誤中學習

> ****there's no mistaking her voice****

> = 她的聲音絕不會認錯

> ****make no mistake****

> = 別搞錯 / 這一點要清楚

So ****mistake**** is much richer than simply:

> ****mistake = 錯誤****

and in your original passage it specifically means:

*****“an incorrect action, judgment, or decision that someone may make without necessarily deserving harsh judgment for it.”****